Wanting

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/51050851.

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Explicit

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Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Mermista (She-Ra), Sea Hawk (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
First Time, Idiots in Love, Vaginal Fingering, Desk Sex, Bed Sex, Neck Kissing, Magicat Catra (She-Ra), Praise Kink, Fluff, Smut, Grinding, Gentle Kissing, tooth rotting smut?? if possible, One Shot, Post-Canon, Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), Adora is a Dork (She-Ra), Catra is Whipped (She-Ra)

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by ari_kari

Summary

The war is over. Horde Prime's death has ushered in an era of unprecedented peace in Etheria, with She-Ra and the Alliance at its helm. And against all odds, Adora has feelings for Catra - loves her, even. Catra's never had more to be grateful for in her life.

Somehow, it's still not enough.

Notes

I've completed 3 fics now, which means I am a ~real au-THOR~. enjoy.

(Tumblr is @ari-kari. Follow for more fic updates!)

See the end of the work for more notes

Catra was starting to panic again.

This was nothing new. Not in the last month, at least. It seemed that ever since she'd decided to "leave her resentments behind" on that ship, anxiety had been racing to fill the gaps. Who knew she'd had all these *emotions* festering in her body this whole time? Sometimes, Catra couldn't help but yearn for the days when she'd solved her problems with claws and a stun wand.

There were no tangible boogeymen left in her closet - Adora had taken care of that (seriously, dissolving Horde Prime with her *mind?* How stupidly attractive could one person get?) Etheria had blossomed into an era of unrivaled peace since the conclusion of the war. These days, the most dangerous thing Catra had to worry about was some kid making grabby hands at Melog when they walked down the street. Even then, she found herself relenting more and more as time went by.

No. Her fears were much more abstract nowadays.

The destruction of the Horde had brought about the exact kind of logistical chaos one would expect from the conclusion of such a life-altering conflict. Refugees from across the planet required immediate sheltering and medical treatment. Geopolitical boundaries, thrown completely into chaos following the collapse of the Fright Zone, were in need of extensive revision. The long and arduous task of reconstruction had only just begun - including mourning the countless souls who hadn't lived to see the war's end.

It was an intense and emotionally-draining process. Catra would know; she had no shortage of responsibilities herself, as an emerging leader of the Etherian restoration process. But her involvement was nothing compared to Adora's. Or should she say *She-Ra's* - because there was much demand for the savior of the universe, Etheria's moral and psychological hub, in the aftermath of the conflict. Adora was on call for just about everything; relief

missions, treaty signings, inaugurations, even the odd wedding or two. And Catra understood that. Truly. She'd moved past her jealous phase (the bulk of it, at least) a long time ago.

They just hadn't really talked much, the last few days.

Catra had watched Adora die in her arms. Months earlier, Adora had endured the same on Horde Prime's ship. It was enough to make Catra want to latch onto Adora's side like a lemur and never let her go. To spend every waking moment in her presence, just for the sheer joy of seeing her alive.

But it hadn't panned out that way. Instead, She-Ra was off saving the world again; this time, from its own bureaucratic incompetence. And Catra, more often than not, was spending her afternoons alone.

That was a pretty dangerous state of existence, for someone like her.

She refused to lash out. Not the way she used to. Honestly, she was *tired* of getting mad at Adora - it'd almost gotten boring, the endless cycle of aggressive accusations and perceived betrayals. But she couldn't help the insidious dread that crept into her stomach with every minute spent wandering the castle corridors after hours. That sick little voice in her head that whispered lies about her worth seemed to have gotten a lot louder these days, and the silence of the hallways at night made it especially difficult to block out.

Adora had barely even touched her since it happened.

OK, maybe that wasn't true. There'd been plenty of kisses since the first one - usually in the rare gaps between public appearances, whenever Adora had time to put her damn tiara down. But they weren't as long, or involved, as Catra would've liked. They'd often end with Adora making an excuse (usually a valid one, unfortunately, given how busy she was) and dashing off to whatever baby-kissing ceremony she was required at next.

Adora loved her. Truly, and without reservation. Even their stolen kisses in the hallway were packed with enough genuine affection to convince Catra of that. But as much as Catra appreciated the time she'd been given so far, it just…wasn't enough. Not to live on permanently. And that scared her - because sometimes, Catra genuinely thought it might be enough for Adora. That she'd be able to survive off of hallway make outs and the odd hand-hold under a table for the rest of their lives.

Only one moment in the last few days had made Catra doubt.

They'd just gotten out of a full-Alliance tactical meeting. Catra had pointed out some dumb strategic thing during the debrief - an innocent comment on how the centrality of the New Scorpion Kingdom made it a valuable asset for regional trade and travel, and that goodwill between Brightmoon and the former Horde residents should take precedence over the enactment of governmental sanctions. Or something. In either case, it was a long speech, and she could feel Adora watching her from beginning to end. At one point, Catra genuinely wondered if she'd said something wrong.

Catra was mistaken.

The moment they made it twenty feet away from the doors, Adora'd had her against the wall. No preamble, no warning. And there were a lot of words Catra could've used to describe that moment - a lot of really good words - but above all else, it was *different*. Different from how they'd kissed before. Adora's skin had started shimmering with a faint but undeniable aura of magic, and she'd run her hands up Catra's body like she wanted to take her apart. And Catra was going to let her. Public decency be damned, she was going to take whatever Adora wanted to give her.

Then a bird flew by. Or maybe a door slammed. Something wholly insignificant, and very ignorable. And like the flip of a switch, Adora had snapped straight back into her old self - the one who

didn’t want Catra *that much* after all. She stepped away with one of those typical dopey grins of hers. Apologized, even.

It had kind of broken Catra’s heart.

Maybe she was wrong for wanting more. They’d only just started seeing each other, if you could call it that; people moved slow in the beginning. *Catra* was the weird one, for having all these intense thoughts and desires for someone she’d only just confessed to a week ago. She needed too much, too soon.

So she played pretend. She took the make outs as they came, and flirted with Adora until she blushed, and it was…good. The nights were lonely, but she had enough time with friends now to stave off the worst of the ache. And for a while, she managed to keep the little voice in her head quiet enough to function.

Because she didn’t want to hurt anyone anymore - *especially* not Adora. If she was starving, it was a problem within herself. A lack of patience she needed to address privately. They had only just discovered this new and beautiful thing between them, after years of ceaseless pain. She couldn’t risk driving Adora away from her just because she wanted things she couldn’t have.

She would rather live in hunger forever than go through that again.

. . .

Catra had been reading when it happened, believe it or not.

Back in the Horde, you would’ve never caught her dead doing something like that. She had a reputation to maintain, after all - the kind that *didn’t* involve reading for fun, like some kind of nerd. Even if she wasn’t allergic to schooling as a general principle, her near-vision had been trash since birth. She didn’t consider squinting uselessly at paper for two hours to be a particularly enjoyable hobby, no matter how much Adora insisted otherwise.

But they had treatments for stuff like that here, apparently. Glimmer had caught her struggling over a maritime treaty one afternoon and, against her feverish protests, had immediately sent for the castle doctor. He'd set her up with a few alchemic concoctions and a pair of glasses for mornings she forgot to take them. (Which was often.) After that, reading had gotten…kind of fun. Not that Catra would ever admit it.

Right now, she was sitting at her desk in the smallest room in Brightmoon Castle - one she'd specifically requested, due to its lack of waterfall. Dinner had concluded a few hours prior; the golden hour of moonset had come and gone, leaving a tranquil evening glow in its wake.

Catra hadn't changed into her nightclothes yet. She was still wearing her red button-up blouse and dark slacks, a holdover from an afternoon diplomatic meeting with the New Scorpion Kingdom. Melog was gone, having disappeared to God knows where for their nightly walk across the castle grounds. They weren't much of a reader either.

She was poring over this old runestone textbook she'd gotten from the castle library. Ostensibly, she'd checked it out to get more information on the inter-kingdom magical network - there'd been a lot of questions about how it worked, now that they'd completely flooded the planet with untapped Heart energy. But Catra had found herself lingering on the passage dedicated to the Sword of Protection instead. Partly because she'd developed a genuine interest in Adora's powers after the events of the last few weeks, and partly because…it made her feel better. Like she was connecting with Adora somehow, even when having her in person felt too out of reach.

In all her readings (and she'd done a lot) there was no mention of She-Ra being activated by something as simple as a kiss. Catra couldn't help but feel a little smug about that - and reassured. If a being as powerful as She-Ra could defy all known limitations of her power just because *Catra* had made her happy, then maybe

Catra's lingering insecurities were wrong. Maybe her and Adora really did have something powerful between them after all.

Catra rubbed her nose, just beneath the bridge of her glasses, and sighed. Stupid. If her past self could see her now - pining over textbooks in slacks and nerd specs - she'd throw a fit. Wasn't she supposed to be some kind of badass, or something? Peacetime had really softened her up.

Right at that moment, things got interesting.

Catra had heard the footsteps coming from miles away - her ears were a lot sharper than her eyes. But she certainly wasn't expecting whoever it was to march right up to her door, pause a moment, and then *barrel right through.* She was up in an instant, claws unsheathed as she awaited the reveal of whatever enemy combatant she'd have to take apart.

…Which was Adora. She'd slid through the entryway with unnatural speed, shutting the door behind her with an unsubtle *click.* After a brief pause, she spun around to face Catra, pinning her arms behind her back in a supposed display of nonchalance. Her cheeks were pink.

"Hey, Adora." Catra sheathed her claws, but remained on her feet. She still wasn't sure whether or not this intrusion represented an actual threat - though Adora's flustered appearance seemed to suggest otherwise.

"Catra! Hi!" Adora responded, grinning sheepishly despite her overwhelm. Unlike Catra, she'd changed into sleep clothes - a long sleeve white shirt with dark, cozy-looking lounge pants. Her brow furrowed slightly as she looked Catra over.

"You wear glasses?"

Now it was Catra's turn to flush red. She tore the frames off of her face as quickly as she could without breaking them. "No. I mean - sometimes. Not really."

Adora's smile eased a bit. "They're really cute."

Catra felt her tail lash out against her will. She cleared her throat to cover as she set the glasses down on the desk.

"I don't, uh - I don't wear them much," she muttered pointlessly. "What are you doing here?"

Adora seemed to remember where she was. She glanced around the room, then bit her lower lip in a way that Catra couldn't help but find cute.

"Sorry. I know it's late, and everything. It's just…" She glanced furtively behind her, then looked back. "Sea Hawk and Mermista are making out in the hallway. Like, *hard."*

Catra's mouth dropped open.

"You're shitting me."

She immediately began heading for the door. Adora's eyes widened.

"Wait, Catra -"

Catra ignored her, pushing gently past her to reach for her knob. "No way. I've got to see this."

After opening the door as silently as she could, she managed to wedge herself in a relatively subtle position between the frames, peeking outward towards the hallway. After a moment, she felt Adora press up behind her.

"Do you see them?" Adora whispered. Her breath was warm against Catra's ear; it made her heart skip.

"Kinda hard to miss," she murmured.

Sea Hawk and Mermista were positioned *very* unsubtly in the far corner of the hallway. Even if they hadn't been obnoxiously easy

to spot, the sounds alone would've been a dead giveaway. It was a *very* intense meetup - even by their standards.

"Fucking gross," Catra muttered, keeping her eyes fixed on the couple in spite of it all.

"*Right?*" She felt Adora shift slightly behind her, craning for a better view. "I'm not trying to sound like a hypocrite or anything, but… *ugh."*

"He looks like he's trying to get her pregnant with his tongue."

Adora giggled. Catra had to resist the urge to lean back and rest her head on Adora's shoulder.

"Am I like that?"

Catra felt her cheeks grow warm. Sea Hawk and Mermista were still going at it, but they seemed less important now. All of Catra's attention had shifted to the girl behind her.

"No." She cleared her throat. "You, uh…have a very light touch. I was kind of surprised."

Adora gave a small noise of protest behind her.

"What's *that* supposed to mean?"

Catra smirked.

"I just figured you'd transfer some of that 'gung-ho' spirit of yours into your technique." She cleared her throat slightly. "But you've been…you're good. You do good."

Adora's small hum of pleasure behind her made her heart warm. She finally succumbed to her building urge, leaning gently backwards against Adora's shoulder. To her relief, she felt a pair of arms snaking around her waist a few moments later. Adora was cozy in her sleepwear; Catra could feel her body heat through their clothes.

Catra let her eyes fall shut. She could get used to this. She wished she'd had the opportunity, so far.

Then -

"Oh God."

Catra's eyes shot open. Mermista seemed to have taken the lead - her tonguing had gotten significantly more aggressive in the last few seconds. And her hand…

Catra felt herself blanch.

"Are they…" Adora asked hesitantly.

Catra's stomach flipped.

"Yep."

She felt Adora's body tense.

"I, uh - I -"

"Abort."

"Right."

In a panic, Catra squeezed out of Adora's arms and back through the doorway, her arms bumping painfully against the side wall. When she looked back, Adora was still rooted in place. She looked like she was paralyzed.

"Adora!"

Adora blinked, like she'd been woken from a spell.

"Sorry!"

She backed, quickly and clumsily, into Catra's torso, Catra stepping backwards towards her own desk to give her space. Adora shut the door with a loud, obvious *thud.*

After a brief moment, she turned. If Catra thought she'd been red before, she was wrong - the girl looked like she'd been scalded.

Almost at the same time, they both burst out in laughter.

Neither of them bothered to keep it quiet. Honestly, Catra had a feeling the lovebirds were a bit too wrapped up to notice them anyways. But all that anxiety and tension needed to go somewhere, and so they laughed, loud and obnoxious, until they were both out of breath.

"I want to die," Adora groaned eventually. "Catra. Please. You have to kill me."

"I *told* you to back away!" Catra laughed, wincing in sympathy. "Now you've seen too much!"

Adora put both of her hands over her face to conceal it. "I panicked! I - the *hallway?"*

Catra didn't have a response for that - other than the fleeting thought that maybe, just maybe, she and Adora had gotten close to that kind of scenario themselves. But she repressed it quickly. She was laughing too hard to linger, anyways.

Catra found herself falling into her chair, its back to her front, while Adora moved to take a seat on her bed near the desk. They spent the next few minutes trying desperately to catch their breath and avoid another relapse, with limited success.

"Is that a She-Ra book?" Adora giggled after a moment, when the worst of their hysteria has faded.

Catra felt the laughter die quickly in her chest, replaced by embarrassment. Adora was peering over at the open page.

"It's - no. It's a runestone book," Catra sputtered. She spins around and shut it, her agitation only weakening her case further.

“Uh huh.” Adora’s voice was annoyingly cocky, even as she giggled. “So you just skipped all the other princesses, then. Unless you really are the fastest reader on Etheria.”

“I could’ve been reading it since the war ended, for all you know,” Catra quipped. “Not like you’ve been coming over here anyways.”

She hadn’t meant to be so petty - it just slipped out. But the statement left an awkward note of tension in the air. Adora’s giggles faded into quiet.

“Yeah,” she said, her smile tinged with sadness now. “Fair enough.”

Catra kicked herself internally for bringing the mood down. Lacking anything else to do, she turned back in her chair towards her book and closed it, shifting it to the side of the desk. After a moment, Adora spoke.

“I’m sorry.”

Catra’s ears flickered with irritation, more towards herself than anyone else. “S’fine. I was just kidding.”

There was a brief, heavy pause. After a moment, Catra felt Adora rise from the bed. She padded up behind her and crouched to her knees behind Catra’s seat.

Soft, strong arms looped around Catra’s waist. She felt Adora’s forehead come to rest gently on the back of her neck.

“Hi,” Adora said sweetly.

Catra’s heart melted. She let some of the tension drain from her muscles.

“Hi.”

Adora exhaled softly through her nose.

They lingered like that a moment, both too content with each other to disrupt the feeling. But eventually, Adora spoke.

"I've missed you," Her breath warmed Catra's fur. "I think about you all the time."

Catra closed her eyes.

"I missed you too," she replied honestly. "Why don't you come by more?"

Adora's grip stilled around her waist.

"Why don't you?"

There was a brief pause as Catra tried to formulate a response.

"I…I didn't know if you wanted me to." She paused. "You've been really busy. And we don't see each other much in between. I figured you were just…resting."

She felt Adora sigh against her neck.

"Even if I am resting, I'd rather rest with you," she admitted quietly. Catra could feel her nervousness now. "I always…I'd probably spend every minute with you, if I could."

Catra felt a week of tension melt off her body at once.

Right at that moment, Adora seemed to hit the limits of her own vulnerability. She released Catra's waist with a quick exhale.

"Sorry," she stammered. "That - that was probably too much."

Catra immediately turned around in her chair. Adora's eyes were pointing obviously downward.

"You think so?" Catra couldn't help but tease, even as she felt her throat tighten. She could feel her heart overflowing with affection.

Adora seemed to sense the dig; she rolled her eyes. “Shut up. I’m trying to apologize.”

And that wiped the smile clean off of Catra’s face. Because there was no way, in any context, she was going to let this girl apologize for the best news Catra had heard in weeks. She could do nothing in that moment other than lean forward, their noses brushing slightly, and touch her lips to Adora’s own.

It was a brief, quiet moment. Catra could sense the other girl’s confusion, even as she responded with her own gentle pressure. But when they parted, Adora’s face was tinged pink. Catra took that as a good sign.

“Adora,” Catra mumbled, pressing another gentle kiss into the corner of her mouth. “I think we were stupid again.”

She could practically hear Adora furrowing her brow as Catra moved for another kiss, this one on her cheek. “We were?”

Catra finally moved back - just enough to see her eyes, which seemed to be brimming with a mixture of hope and confusion. She brought her arms to rest on Adora’s shoulders over the back of the chair.

“Mhm,” she said, planting a soft kiss directly between her eyes. “The communication thing. We forgot to do it again.”

Finally, she saw Adora give a hesitant smile.

“Really?”

“Yeah.” She couldn’t help but smile back. “I forgot to tell you how absolutely crazy I am about you. And you forgot to tell me.”

Finally - *finally* - she felt Adora relax beneath her.

“Oh.” Another dumb, sweet giggle. “Yeah. We’re pretty stupid, huh?”

“Idiots,” Catra chuckled. Her eyes dropped briefly to Adora’s lips, then flicked back up. “Kiss me.”

She wasn’t ready for the response.

Adora moved towards her with such immediacy that Catra barely had time to breathe before their lips met. The contact was gentle, but the energy was not - Adora’s soft, full lips slid against hers with an obvious hunger that made Catra’s heart race. She pulled Adora towards her immediately, drinking in her gasp as she did.

Things built quickly. Adora’s tongue edged into her mouth after a moment of hesitation; it was hot, and wet, and *so* much softer than Catra’s own. Every rational instinct was driven from her body. Soon Catra was leaning up against her, hands sliding eagerly up Adora’s neck. Pushing further, further -

The chair tipped forward onto two legs.

Catra parted with a gasp just as Adora surged forward to catch her, holding her close as she tilted the chair back to its place. It settled on the hard floor with a loud, dramatic rattle.

For a moment, they just sat there, breathing through the adrenaline. Catra could feel her face turning pink already.

“Sorry,” Adora panted.

When Catra pulled back to look, she found that Adora was similarly flustered. Her ponytail was a bit disheveled on top; wispy hairs were strewn across her forehead.

“I, uh - I got a little carried away.” Adora glanced downward as she blushed, a sheepish grin on her face. “Again.”

Catra could feel her stomach twisting inside her as Adora rose to her feet, smoothing Catra’s hair down with her hand. What she wouldn’t give for Adora to get carried away. To carry them *both* away. The electricity in the air was thick enough to be cut with a sword; Catra wasn’t sure how much longer she could take it.

But she didn't press. Not then. She needed to wait.

"I was actually coming to see you *before* all the Mermista drama happened," Adora confessed, hopping onto the desk behind her. "The 'running in without knocking' thing was for my own safety."

Catra laughed, letting the tension in her body ease somewhat. Her glasses had gotten knocked to the floor at some point in the last few minutes; she stood up from the chair and pushed it aside to pick them up, dusting them carelessly with her shirt before slipping them into the desk drawer. "Understandable. That's a life-or-death emergency."

Adora chuckled. Catra could hear her swinging her legs against the desk. She was such a kid.

When Catra looked up again, there was a strange new energy in Adora's eyes. She looked like she was trying to get the courage to say something - but Catra herself lacked the courage to pry.

Finally, after a moment of eye contact, she spoke.

"Do you think they're in love? Sea Hawk and Mermista?"

It was an innocent enough question in any other context. But their old energy hadn't quite faded away. And for some reason, Catra found herself turning her back on Adora out of nerves as she spoke.

"Hard to say," Catra replied, staring pointedly at the door. She chuckled nervously. "Think my version of love might look a little different than theirs."

She felt Adora's legs still behind her.

"What does yours look like?"

Catra's pulse quickened.

She found herself leaning backwards, ever so slightly, until her seat was pressed against the desk between Adora's legs. Her eyes remained locked on the door.

"It's a big word." Catra's blood began to heat as she felt Adora's legs squeezing softly on either side of her waist. "You want the long answer or the short one?"

A brief pause - and then, she felt Adora's arms wrapping around her torso, just below her chest, gently tugging Catra close.

"I just want yours," Adora murmured.

Her fingers ran lightly down the underside of Catra's arm. They left a trail of sparks in their wake.

"Lot of it's physical, I guess," Catra began softly. The fingers made another journey along the length of her arm. Up and down. "You just…want to be in contact with them all the time. Want to touch them. Want them to touch you."

Adora hummed low in her chest. Catra felt her lean forward a bit… and then, a pair of gentle lips were pressing into the base of one of her ears. It sent a thrill down her spine.

"Like that?" Adora whispered.

Catra swallowed.

"Yeah." Her heart pounded in her throat. "But more."

She felt Adora immediately move to obey, pressing a long, heavy kiss on the side of Catra's jaw and beginning to work her way down the soft fur of Catra's throat. Catra couldn't help the exhale that escaped her chest.

"Tell me more," Adora breathed, between kisses.

Her right hand had made its way upward, coming to rest on the open spot of Catra's button up. Her fingers traced lightly over the

soft fur of Catra's sternum, only occasionally dipping any lower - and even then, just for a moment. Soft and teasing.

Catra could feel her body beginning to hum, from nerves and anticipation and barely-restrained *want*. She pushed backwards into Adora's chest, giving her exploring hands and lips as much space as she could.

"It's more than just physical," Catra breathed, her tail lashing furiously behind her. She wrapped it tight around Adora's arm in a desperate bid to maintain control.

"Yeah?" Adora's own breath was heavy now.

"Yeah." More kisses - hands wandering lower, gripping her tighter. "It's - emotional. Loving someone. More emotion than you've ever felt in your life."

"Tell me," Adora whispered breathlessly. Another kiss. "*Please*."

And…oh. It did something to her, hearing Adora beg like that. Awakened a raw, aching part of herself she'd never fully allowed to surface. Without thinking, she backed up, roughly, into Adora's chest, both of them gasping at the impact. Seconds later, arms were tightening around Catra body, pulling her dangerously close.

"*Catra*." Her voice was music to Catra ears - her kisses had grown hot and open mouthed, pressing at her skin with a sweet urgency that made her body vibrate.

"It hurts," Catra managed. "Loving someone." She ran her hands firmly up Adora's strong arms, eager for contact. "It feels like the best thing on the planet sometimes, but most of the time you just… *hurt*. Like - like you're being carved out from the inside."

Adora whimpered in her ear, tugging her impossibly close. Surrendering to her pull, Catra found herself tugged backward onto the desk between Adora's legs - finally grounded, her back to Adora's front. She felt her heart plunge down to her abdomen.

“But you don’t want it to stop,” Catra gasped. Her mind had begun to cloud past the point of conscious awareness; Adora’s mouth was driving her insane. “Because it’s still - it’s the best thing you’ve ever felt. And you feel sorry for other people, sometimes. That they’ll never - get to hurt as badly as you are.”

Just for a moment - almost imperceptibly - Adora stilled. Catra’s own hands slowed in response; she fought to get her breathing under control. She wondered, suddenly, if she’d made a mistake.

Then Catra felt Adora’s left hand creep beneath her shirt and lie flat against her lower abdomen.

“It hurts me, too.”

A molten heat like she had never known pooled in Catra’s center. She let her head fall back against Adora’s shoulder.

It was a dream. A fantasy. For all the nights she’d woken up in a warm flush, the ghost of Adora’s hands running over her body, she’d never in a million years imagined that it could actually *happen.* And even now, as Adora began to rub gentle circles into her lower belly, Catra still couldn’t believe it. Surely, Adora would back away. She’d take her hands off of Catra’s body - stutter an apology, go back to her room - and Catra would never allow herself to dream again.

Adora didn’t back away.

“Tell me what you want,” Adora murmured, her voice low. One hand found Catra’s hair now, threading itself in its choppy waves, while the other began to stroke across Catra’s stomach. “Tell me how to love you. Please.”

Catra couldn’t stop herself from whimpering as the ache inside her grew. She had never needed something more in her life - but vocalizing it felt impossible. Her eyes slammed shut with pure overwhelm. She would die if she was wrong about this. She’d die if she wasn’t.

“I don’t know,” Catra panted - *lied*. She found herself burying her face in Adora’s neck, her breaths coming hard and erratic. “I don’t - I don’t know.”

“Do you want me to stop -“

“*No.”* Mindless and frantic, Catra mouthed at the underside of Adora’s jaw - felt her hum reverberating against her lips when she did. “No. Please.”

Adora’s breath caught in her throat. Catra felt her stomach flip as Adora’s fingers dipped even lower across her abdomen - just above the hem of Catra’s pants.

“Do you want me to touch you, Catra?” Adora whispered.

Oh my God.

Catra’s heart stopped. Her mouth, inches away from the skin of Adora’s neck, was suddenly bone dry.

“Yeah,” she managed eventually, voice strained. “Do - do you want to touch me?”

It wasn’t two seconds later before Catra felt Adora’s fingernails scraping lightly over her scalp. Her other hand crept ever so slightly lower, until she was fingering the button of Catra’s waistband.

“Yeah.”

It was too much, all of this. Too incredible, and too much. Her ears had long since gone flat in a gesture of total submission. Without thinking, she bridged the gap between her lips and Adora’s neck, sucking right above her pulse point.

Adora’s moan was nearly enough to finish her on the spot.

In seconds, the button was released; Adora pulled the zipper down with an agonizing slowness, exposing the soaked underwear

beneath. Catra released the reddening skin of Adora's neck with a pop, kissing the spot over and over as a desperate fever took hold of her body.

"Catra," Adora choked, her fingers finally dipping below the waistband and threading softly through her slicked curls. "I *really* love you."

Right as the words hit Catra's ears, she made contact.

And *fuck* - this would be over in minutes. Seconds. She'd never been this overwhelmed with desire in her entire life - never been touched so gently in her life - and it was melting her from the inside. Everything was perfect. None of it was real.

"Tell me again," Catra gasped. Adora's fingers were already wet, slipping roughly over her most sensitive parts. "I - please."

Adora's breath was hot in her ear. Catra belonged to her now.

"I love you, Catra. So much. I always have. I lo -" Her legs tightened. "I *want* you."

Catra's breathing was ragged as Adora worked her over. Her other hand had slipped, finally, beneath the open collar of her button-up - found her nipples, uninhibited by any barrier, and started circling them with a steady, feverish touch. Catra's moan reverberated hot against Adora's neck.

"I'm never going to stop saying it," Adora insisted. The words spilled recklessly from her mouth. "Never. I'm going to keep telling you, over and over, until you're sick of it, and sick of *me*, and I just - fuck, I *love* you. You're everything."

They were both so impossibly far gone already. Catra could never be sure if Adora had come into her room with this in mind, and she would've never dared to imagine it herself - but they were here now. And it was so good, and she did not deserve it, but she had the rest of her life to make it up to her and she fully intended to do so, for as long as Adora would let her.

Something else was changing. Catra could sense it, even as her pleasure mounted and her eyes squeezed shut. The energy in the room had grown charged, the body behind her beginning to shift. It had been subtle at first, but was now undeniable. Adora was glowing.

Somehow, it didn't feel like anything other than inevitable.

"*Adora,"* Catra cried out. She was close. There was no separation between their bodies now - she was practically in Adora's lap, her hips jerking upward in tiny, desperate thrusts. Adora tightened her hold in response, bearing her through. Light danced beneath Catra's eyelids.

"I've got you, Catra," she exhaled. Her left arm held Catra tight. "I'm here."

Catra was mindless now. Adora had full control over every part of her - she was soft and malleable as putty in her hands, completely surrendered to her will. And Catra didn't care. She loved those hands. She loved the person attached to them. She was safe.

"You're - Beautiful. You're *so* beautiful," Adora whispered. "I've got you. I'm not letting you go."

Finally, Catra broke.

She didn't remember what sounds she made, or how loud. It didn't matter anymore. Only Adora, her fingers gradually slowing as she worked Catra through, was important. Pleasure coursed through her body in waves. She was going to push into Adora until their bodies were one. She was going to squeeze past Adora's ribs and live inside her forever.

But the waves eventually fell away, reduced to smaller and smaller aftershocks that subsided into an all-consuming stillness. And Catra found herself just as content to relax against Adora's body and be held by those soft, strong arms instead. Her mind went totally blank as a rumbling purr started up in her chest; her temple came to rest against Adora's neck. She thought of nothing.

But it was hard to ignore the light forever. It danced obviously behind her eyelids, inviting inspection. When she finally cracked a bleary eye open, she saw that her suspicions had been more than some mid-climax hallucination - Adora's skin was glowing. It was luminous in the dim evening light, even as it had already begun to fade.

When she finally lifted her head to look Adora in the eyes, she was biting her lip.

"Sorry," Adora mumbled, looking wildly embarrassed. "I guess I got a little too excited."

Catra couldn't stop a massive, lazy grin from stretching across her face.

"This some sort of special She-Ra bonus power?" Catra asked. She moved to trail a thumb across Adora's cheek. "Because if so, I can definitely get used to it."

Somehow, even with the glow, Catra could tell Adora was blushing.

"Better than it was before, I guess," Adora chuckled nervously, tightening her grip around Catra's waist. Her skin was slowly turning back to normal now - only a faint shimmer remained. "I honestly thought I was gonna transform, there, for a bit."

Catra can't help but laugh at the mental image that produced.

"You probably would've broken the desk," she said, nestling once more into the crook of Adora's neck. "It would've been awesome. We're definitely doing that next time."

Adora's laughter is music to her ears.

"Seriously, though," she said, pressing against Catra's hair with her chin. "We're gonna have to be careful. She-Ra's - uh, bigger, than I am. I don't want to hurt you by mistake."

It took Catra a moment for the meaning to click. When it did, she extricated herself from Adora's grip, then turned and slipped her leg over Adora's lap until she was straddling it. Her arms came to rest over Adora's shoulders.

"You planning on putting something inside me, Princess?" she asked wolfishly.

It had the desired effect. Adora blushed pretty pink for her, even as her eyes held Catra's own.

"If you want me inside you," Adora said evenly, her lips flickering down to Catra's, "then…yeah."

Catra's body thrummed.

She would take Adora up on that. Gladly, repeatedly, and without hesitation. But there were other things occupying her mind right then. Like how hungrily Adora seemed to be looking at her, even as she pretended otherwise. The pink in her cheeks; her sweet, parted lips. She'd been so easy to work up. Maybe Catra could make her feel good too.

Maybe Catra just wanted to try.

Slowly, she leaned forward until her lips were brushing the soft skin of Adora's neck. Her movements were slow; she couldn't resist flicking the tip of her tongue out to stroke the surface. Adora shuddered in her arms.

"Hey, Adora," she said innocently, pressing another humming kiss onto her pulse point. "I think we forgot something."

"Yeah?" Despite the sudden hitch in Adora's breathing, Catra could identify a note of genuine confusion in her voice. "Wh - uh, what?"

Catra smiled against her skin. Emboldened now, she mouthed openly against Adora's neck, drawing her tongue up the column of

her throat in a slow rasp. She marked off Adora's gasp of surprise with a soft, chaste kiss at the edge of Adora's jaw.

"You."

Adora's laugh is riddled with obvious nerves. But she doesn't reject the idea. Catra takes it as confirmation.

"Adora." Catra's tail slides up and over Adora's arm, trailing down the length, as she threads her hands loosely in the other girl's hair. Her pulse begins to race alongside Adora's breathing. "If someone loved you - more than anything - how would they show you?"

Adora's eyes were closed now. Despite the levity, Catra could see her actively fighting her own desire; her brow furrowed slightly with the effort.

"They'd take it easy," Adora tried weakly. "Get some rest."

Catra wasn't sure Adora had ever told a funnier joke in her life.

In a single, graceful movement, Catra slipped down off of Adora's lap and planted her feet on the floor. She readjusted her hands on Adora's shoulders just long enough to plant a quick kiss on her cheekbone. Then she let them trail down - smoothing over Adora's arms, and lifting them up gently so that *they* were propped on *her* shoulders instead. As Adora regarded her with dazed bewilderment, Catra brought her own hands down, smoothing over the fabric of Adora's pants and wedging them gently beneath Adora's thighs.

Catra smirked - and suddenly, Adora understood.

"Wait a second." Her eyes went wide. "What are you -"

Catra lifted Adora off of the desk and into her arms with zero warning whatsoever.

"*Catra!"* Adora shrieked, tightening her hold on Catra's neck with a frantic giggle. There was no need, though. Catra had her.

"You think you're the only one with muscles around here?" Catra teased. Her hands gripped firmly beneath Adora's legs as she carried them both towards the bed.

It was only about a five foot journey, but totally worth it - Adora looked at Catra like she was her own personal goddess. Seemingly overcome, she pressed her own soft kisses onto Catra's cheeks as they moved.

Catra deposited her on the bed, jokingly abrupt; it earned a few more laughs from Adora. But her smile faded as she regarded Catra above her. And now, Catra had to pause for breath - because the sight of Adora splayed out beneath her, flushed and breathless, was almost enough to rob her of her strength.

Instead, she climbed on top, pinning her waist with her own, and relished in the way Adora's eyes traveled eagerly across her face. It had been so long since Catra'd seen her this *willing*. She wanted nothing more than to make her happy.

"Pretty girl," Catra murmured, threading her fingers through Adora's long, blonde hair. "When's the last time anyone's done something nice for you, huh?"

And, oh - that did more than Catra could've ever dreamed. The words alone were enough to blow Adora's pupils out to twice their original size. Catra could feel her going soft and pliant beneath her fingers.

"Long time, I bet," Catra whispered reverently, tracing gentle claw tips over Adora's scalp. Affection pounded in her veins; she could feel herself beginning to tremble with the sheer magnitude of it. "Poor baby. Let me take care of you."

Catra could tell, even as she leaned forward to kiss her, that Adora was beginning to glow again.

This time, it was Adora who did the taking - reaching hungrily to pull her down, her lips crashing against Catra's as if her life depended on it. Catra returned her affections hard and slow, savoring her with an unhurried reverence as she moaned sweetly against her. Catra's fingers grew progressively more entangled in Adora's hair as they kissed, her touches progressing from gentle strokes to light tugs. And all the while, Adora's light grew brighter and brighter.

When they finally broke apart, Catra's already-spent air was knocked straight out of her. Adora was glowing, yes - but from the way she was looking up at her, breathless and completely unguarded, you would think that *Catra* was some sort of miracle. It made the world around her go quiet like never before.

"Can I see you?" Catra pleaded, running a smooth hand up the side of Adora's torso. All of her flirty confidence had vanished - she was lost in this moment now, caught hopelessly in whatever magic Adora had brought into the room. From the look in Adora's eyes, dark and raw despite the dancing light around her, she wasn't alone.

"Please," Adora whispered.

She didn't move, despite her obvious yearning - she wanted Catra to take the lead. And Catra was more than happy to do so. Without saying a word, she peeled Adora's soft white shirt over her head, then pulled at the tight sports top beneath. It made a swishing noise against the muscles of Adora's arms as Catra tugged it upward and discarded it on the ground.

And then…

"Beautiful."

There was nothing else to say. The luminous glow of her skin, and the swell of her breasts, and *her,* every part of her - it was too much. Catra could do nothing but run her fingers lightly down the center of her chest, voice shaking with pure reverence. "You are

so - you are so beautiful, Adora. You're the most incredible thing I've ever seen."

And though Catra had not touched her yet when she suckled Adora's nipple into her mouth, she was beginning to believe she genuinely might not need to. Because the movement of her tongue across the bud was enough to make Adora *moan* aloud, voice breaking like she was about to cry. Her hips jerked upward, quick and reflexive.

"Easy," Catra whispered against her skin, barring Adora's hips with her forearm as she gave Adora's other nipple a brief, easy loll with her tongue. "I've got you."

It was hard to avoid getting lost in Adora's body. Catra had been watching it from afar since they were young - regarding it with a torrid combination of envy and desire for as long as she could remember. But now that she had permission to touch - to savor - she gave it everything she had. She ran her tongue along Adora's torso, from the edge of her bellybutton to the swell of her breasts, and it was the sweetest thing she had ever tasted in her life.

"Catra," Adora gasped suddenly. Her breathing was ragged, like she'd run a mile in the last few minutes alone. "*Catra."*

The urgency snapped Catra immediately from her trance. She lifted her head up from Adora's chest.

"Are you OK?" Alarm surged through her chest. She'd made a mistake. She'd fucked up and hurt her again.

Before Catra had time to properly panic, Adora's hands were on her face - cupping her jaw, tangling urgently in her hair. Her eyes were wild with something she couldn't seem to express in words.

"You're - you're just -"

Her hand trailed downward, coming to rest flat over Catra's heart. She could feel her pulse beginning to race in response.

“Please let me see you,” Adora begged.

And then Catra was shucking off her top with more urgency than she’d ever had in her life - because she would do *anything* for Adora if she asked her like that. She’d kill a person. She’d kill *herself.* All she needed was for Adora to beg her with that quiet, desperate little voice, and it would be done.

If Catra thought Adora was enraptured before, this was something else entirely. The light in the room flickered noticeably brighter as Adora dragged her eyes over Catra’s naked body. She didn’t speak - Catra wasn’t sure if she could. She just reached out with tentative hands and stroked, lightly, over the downy fur of Catra’s chest.

Suddenly, Catra felt more exposed than she ever had before, even when she was being touched. She was hyperaware, suddenly, of the differences between her features and Adora’s. It was challenging not to draw comparisons - and really, how could hers *possibly* compare? She was sitting naked in front of a literal goddess. Catra’s body was…insignificant, alongside hers. Nothing.

But she didn’t feel like nothing right then, even with her mind working overdrive to poison her - because Adora was looking at her like she was *everything.* It didn’t seem possible, but Catra knew Adora well enough to know that she couldn’t act to save her life. Those reverent eyes and searching hands were real.

It took her breath away.

“Catra…” Adora tried. Her words died in her throat.

When Catra met her eyes, she realized suddenly that they had changed - turned an unnatural, crystalline blue. And too late, she understood what was happening. Adora’s breaths were coming too quickly; there was a sense of unexpressed panic in her movements. She was freaking out.

“Hey,” Catra said, gentle but firm. She immediately moved to shift off of Adora and settle at her side. Her hand came to rest over

Adora’s heart; it was fluttering rapid fire. “Adora. Can you look at me?”

Adora didn’t turn. She just laughed, short and hysterical. She knew she’d been caught.

“Baby,” Catra said softly. “Look at me.”

Finally, Adora turned her head. Her eyes were unnaturally bright.

“Sorry,” she breathed. Her smile was a bit out of control. “I didn’t mean to turn into a lightbulb.”

Catra couldn’t help but laugh at that. She started rubbing the skin of Adora’s chest with the ball of her thumb.

“I don’t care if you’re a lightbulb, Adora,” she chuckled softly. “I just want you to relax a bit.”

Even through the glow, Catra could see Adora’s skin flushing. Her smile eased as she let out an embarrassed huff. “Sorry. I - sorry.”

“Are you OK?” Catra asked. “Do you want to stop for now?”

Adora shook her head with an almost feverish intensity.

”No. Definitely not.” Her eyes trailed over Catra’s face. “I just...literally can’t process how incredible you are.”

Catra couldn’t respond to that. She wouldn’t. Instead, she pulled Adora into a firm embrace, wrapping an arm around her back as they lay chest to chest.

This girl would be the death of her.

They spent a moment catching their breath. Catra began to press featherlight kisses against her face as her hand trailed its way up Adora’s spine. She worried for a moment that she would work her up again, but the opposite seemed to happen - Adora’s muscles

finally went lax against her, her light fading to a faint, barely-there glow as they matched each other's breaths.

When Adora nosed upward to find her lips again, it felt better than it had before. Their movements were easy and intentional; the yearning, still present, was a gentle undertone beneath the surface. Catra could still feel Adora's pulse beating strongly beneath her ribs, but it no longer felt out of control.

Adora's eyes were back to their normal, soft blue when they broke apart. But the energy between them hadn't faded. Catra could feel it traveling beneath her skin as they met each other's eyes.

"Catra?" Adora asked softly

Catra's lips flickered downward. "Yeah?"

There was a quiet pause. Then Adora brought her lips forward to brush against the feathered edges of Catra's ear. The contact sent a chill down her spine.

"I want you to touch me."

Every bone in Catra's body turned to jelly.

She didn't respond. There was no need. Catra could sense that her own pupils, far more sensitive than Adora's, had widened to saucers. Words wouldn't cut it anymore.

She was going to give her what she wanted.

Catra started with a kiss - a simple touch of their lips that grew longer and heavier in a very short time. Soon, Catra was stroking deep against Adora's tongue, laving over her teeth and lips - *taking* Adora with her mouth alone. She channeled decades of repressed longing into that one, simple movement. By the time she was finished, Adora was moaning beneath her, her lips pink and perfectly swollen. But Catra wasn't finished. Not even close.

She moved onto Adora's neck. She'd been paying attention, when they kissed, to the places Adora liked most. Now Catra settled on one of her favorites - the soft little spot where her neck met her jaw. After dragging her tongue languidly over the skin, Catra suckled it lightly into her mouth - not to bruise, but to taste.

Catra could feel Adora beginning to roll her hips against her once more, her light shining ever brighter. But that was OK - Catra wasn't worried anymore. What she was about to do would relax her soon enough.

"Adora," Catra murmured. To her alarm, she realized she was a bit choked up; she swallowed hard, then spoke. "Adora. I'm gonna take care of you."

The quiet moan that came from Adora's mouth said more than words ever could.

Catra set about peppering kisses onto the most sensitive parts of Adora's throat - and as she did, her hand began to trail downward. Past the beautiful curves of Adora's breasts. Past the strong, lithe muscles of her abdomen. Past the divots of her hips. Down, down, down.

She expected to need confirmation when she reached the waistband, but she was mistaken - Adora wasted no time shucking them off, tossing them to the side with zero ceremony or hesitation. Maybe she was too anxious for further teasing. Maybe she really did want Catra as badly as Catra wanted her. There wasn't much time to consider the matter, though. Catra had a job to do.

She trailed downward, over the crest of Adora's skin, and made contact.

The touch made Adora's eyes pop wide open; she looked like she'd been electrified. But before Catra had time to check in, Adora was burying her face in Catra's neck, placing hot, open-mouthed kisses over her fur. Catra's own lust kicked back into

gear as she began rubbing her with slow, building strokes, burying her other hand solidly in Adora's hair. She was so wet. Soaking wet - and all for her.

"Good girl. You're so good. I love you so much."

She didn't know what she was doing, really. And that scared her a bit - she wanted Adora to feel as good as she had, if not better. But she tried to put that desperation out of her mind, and focus on the simple, mindless pleasure of just touching her. Adora moaning quietly against her between kisses was almost enough to break her mind. It was a sense of deep joy she'd never known.

When Adora began grinding against the heel of her hand, Catra took her lead; she applied direct, even contact, giving Adora the surface area she needed, and let her fingers reach downward towards her entrance. Adora had already responded ardently to the increased pressure, rolling her hips needily against Catra's hand; when she felt Catra playing around her edges, she whined into her shoulder. That snapped the last of Catra's restraint. She dipped her fingers into Adora's wet, beautiful heat, and the other girl cried out against her.

"Fuck," she breathed. "You're so - you -"

She immediately began to grind into the contact.

They lost themselves, then - Catra did, at least. There was no other proper response to seeing such a beautiful girl moving against your body like that. Adora's hips were rolling faster by the second, the muscles of her core tensing and releasing around Catra's fingers. It was almost too incredible to process. The kind of dream Catra was never allowed to have.

She was awestruck.

"*Catra*." Adora's breathing grew erratic on Catra's neck. "I'm cl - I think I'm -"

“I know,” Catra replied quickly. Her voice was rough with emotion, but she prayed Adora was too far gone to hear it. She tugged her close, letting Adora’s face settle in the crook of her neck. “I know, baby. You’re OK.”

Adora whined. Catra wanted to commit every second of this moment into memory. She was unworthy of this. She always would be - but it was *so* beautiful. Indescribably, unimaginably beautiful.

“I’m here, Adora,” Catra murmured. “I've got you. You can let go.”

Her sharp cry echoed in the room seconds later.

Catra clung to her throughout. She rubbed her fingers gently across Adora’s scalp as her hips rocked to a choking stillness against Catra’s hand. It did something to her, watching Adora chase the pleasure with every slow, shuddering roll. It changed something deep inside her.

When Adora finally went slack against her, a great, heavy peace settled across the entire room. Catra couldn’t help but feel like she had gone through the entire process with her, with how absolutely spent she was. She lifted her fingers to her mouth and licked them one by one, savoring the taste without the burden of thought. Adora lay contentedly in her arms as she did, breathing against her fur. Catra was at peace.

She wasn’t sure Adora had ever been this physically relaxed in her life - not to Catra’s knowledge, at least. The girl at her side could just as easily be asleep, if the memory of what they’d just done wasn’t burned into Catra’s memory. She looked younger than Catra had ever seen, even as the glowing aura that surrounded them had begun to fade.

But when her blue eyes finally opened, Catra could see that they were tinged with sadness. It made Catra’s stomach drop. If she’d

misread this situation even a little bit - if she'd pushed Adora too far - she'd never forgive herself.

After a heavy moment, Adora spoke.

"I'm sorry we had sex on a desk."

Catra blinked. Twice. The meaning behind the words, clearly quite important to Adora, was going straight over her head.

"…What?"

Adora shifted a little in the bed beside her. Her expression was painfully earnest.

"I'm sorry you had your first time with me on a desk," she said genuinely. "It's not fair. You deserved so much better than that."

Catra can only hold the laughter back for a few seconds before it bursts out of her chest.

Adora does her best to look offended, even as an embarrassed smile plays at her lips. "*What?* How is that funny?"

Catra was too busy laughing to respond. Instead, she rolled on top of Adora and pinned her wrists lazily beneath her hands, earning an adorable squeak of protest.

"Catraaaa," she whined. "I'm serious. You were so good to me. I - I shouldn't have let it happen.

Catra finally shoved her laughter down. A massive, splitting grin was threatening to take over her entire face, but she repressed it for a moment, adopting a false aire of comportment instead.

"I'm going to say this once," Catra began, biting the inside of her cheek to maintain her deadpan. "And only once. So you better not forget. But let me be very clear - fucking me on that desk was the best and most important thing you have ever done in your life. And that includes ending an intergalactic war."

A giggle immediately burst out of Adora's chest, purely from shock. Catra ignored it and continued, poking at Adora's cheek with her finger for emphasis.

"I am going to be thinking about you fucking me on that desk from now until we die. *Every* time I pass it. I'm almost definitely going to make you do it again. And when I *do* die, I want an image of you fucking me on that desk superimposed onto my tombstone, so that it can remain in the Etherian historical record until the end of time." She gave a final jab for emphasis. "Got it?"

Adora's mouth was hanging open.

"You…are *so* weird." Another laugh escapes her chest; her eyes are bright. "You are literally the weirdest person I've ever met. In the whole galaxy."

Catra finally allowed herself to grin.

"I know," Catra said, cupping her jaw with her hands. "And you *love* me. What does that say about you?"

Adora was smiling as she rose to meet Catra's lips clumsily with her own.

Everything was OK, Catra thought, as they settled into each other once again. It didn't make sense to her that things could be this good, but she didn't have the will or energy to question it anymore. They were here. They were both alive. For now, that was enough.

And then, an unmistakable whooshing sound filled the air.

There was a good five seconds where both parties held stock still, fighting desperately to process what they were seeing. Catra, staring at the short-haired princess who'd teleported directly into her room. Glimmer, at the sight of her two best friends lying fully naked in each other's arms.

Then the screaming started.

*"What the **fuck**, Sparkles?!!"*

"*Ahhhhhh!"*

Glimmer immediately teleported again - and wound up a few feet away, right next to the desk. She stumbled as the legs of the chair tangled hopelessly with her own.

"What are you *doing* here?!?"

"I didn't know this was happening!!" Glimmer screamed, desperately scrambling to find her footing. She only succeeded in falling flat on her ass again.

"I - how? *Why?"* Catra cried. "Why are you here in the first place!?"

"Because Sea Hawk is *fingerbanging Mermista* in the hallway!" Glimmer had her eyes closed now and was stumbling blindly around the room in search of the door.

"So you thought you'd just - fucking teleport in?*"*

"I panicked!" Glimmer hissed. "And I wanted to *tell* somebody! How was I supposed to know it'd be worse in here than out there?!?"

Catra gave her an incredulous glare. "Because we're *dating*, you sparkly psychopath!"

Adora had finally managed to cover both of their bodies with a sheet and was now composed enough to rejoin the conversation. "Glimmer, you - you're going the wrong way -"

"*Fuck*." Glimmer hit the desk again. Catra had to suppress a bout of hysterical cackling.

"Why don't you just teleport -"

"***Because I'm flustered!!"***

And just like that, Glimmer disappeared into a cloud of sparkles.

The air in the room was stifling. Catra was suddenly hyperaware of the blood rushing to her face; a quick glance at Adora revealed that she was similarly crimson.

"You OK?" Catra asked warily.

Adora looked at the ceiling for a moment. Gave a quick nod. Opened her mouth -

Another whoosh.

"Glimmer!"

She held up a finger, her expression abnormally calm.

"I'm going to leave. And I'm not going to come back. Ever. But I have to know." She inhaled. "Was she *glowing* just now? Like, did you guys turn She-Ra into some sort of weird sex thing -"

"Leave."

Glimmer pressed her lips into a pout.

"Fine!" Glimmer cried, dusting herself off imperiously. "Use protection, dipshit. Don't leave any puncture holes in my mom's sheets."

And then, she was gone.

The silence bore down on them once more. But this time, when Catra met Adora's eyes, she could tell they were on the same page. And the thought in their minds was this - it was really, *really* hard to feel genuinely humiliated around Glimmer.

So instead, they both began to laugh.

Catra knew they were screwed from the time it started, and she was right - they were hysterical within seconds. She found herself

laying across Adora's stomach, laughing painfully into the bedspread as she buried her face in her pillow."

"That was - that was awful," Adora gasped. "That was literally the worst thing that's ever happened to me."

"Even the whole Horde Prime thing?" Catra wheezed, her body wracked with pain.

"Yes," Adora choked, completely serious. "I'd go one-on-one with that man in a heartbeat if it meant erasing that moment from *all* of our memories. I'd bring him back to life right now."

Catra was literally howling.

"The desk," she eventually managed, fumbling blindly for Adora's hand in her laughter. "She ran into the desk. *Two times."*

Adora lost it, too.

It was a while before it'd left their system. In hindsight, it felt like a flush of toxins from just about everything they'd endured the past few weeks. It felt good, in truth, to be worked up over something so inconsequential for once. It made Catra feel safe.

They were breathless when they finished, both of them. At some point, Catra's own giggles had devolved into quick, soft kisses against Adora's cheek, and their mirth had eased into affection once again. Adora's hands were around Catra's waist, the latter on top as their legs criss-crossed beneath them.

"We'll need to plan a revenge mission now," Catra insisted, wrapping her tail affectionately around Adora's wrist. "Catch her and Arrow Boy in the act."

"You go right ahead. I don't actually *want* to see that," Adora laughed, wrinkling her nose.

"Just hold my hand when we go in," Catra grinned, planting a light kiss on Adora's knuckles for emphasis. "You can keep your eyes

closed. Like Glimmer did."

Adora didn't reply. She just looked at Catra, a strangely tender expression on her face. Catra's smile faded a bit.

"What?"

Adora's own smile softened. Catra felt her start to play with the tip of her tail, lightly working it over with her fingers. Her other hand tightened in Catra's own.

"I think you might be the best thing that's ever happened to me."

Catra's heart bled.

Gently, she eased herself up until she was sitting on Adora's lap, chest to chest. Words couldn't express what was going on inside her. She just pulled her close, as tight as she could, and buried her face in Adora's hair.

"I *know* you are," Catra whispered.

Adora sighed.

They surrendered once again to the stillness.

They'd end up breaking into Glimmer's room a few nights later - Adora with her eyes closed, as promised. Catra would be disappointed (and slightly relieved) to find that they'd interrupted nothing more than a *very* enthusiastic attempt at an aerial dance lift between her and Bow - which they'd apparently been practicing for hours with little success. Adora would later con Catra into trying the exact same move a few minutes later; they'd immediately blow Sparkles and Arrow Boy out of the water, much to their chagrin.

And the peace would continue. The *world* would continue - constantly evolving, though not always for the better. There would be struggles that pushed the boundaries of their endurance, and

tested them to the core of who they were and who they'd become.

But things would feel different than they had at the Horde - where Adora had felt like a precious commodity, a reward that Catra never quite knew how to earn. They were a team now. No matter what they faced, they would face it together.

Adora would stay. And Catra would too.

End Notes

i was picturing the lift from dirty dancing can’t lie.

thanks for reading ❤️ ❤️ ❤️

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